
WES HENDERSON

STAFF SYSTEMS ENGINEER

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AUTOMATION ENGINEERING | CONTAINERIZATION | LINUX/UNIX

Automation-focused Systems Engineer with 10+ years of experience in designing, integrating, and optimizing scalable infrastructure in cloud-native environments. Strong Linux advocate with deep technical acumen in automation, DevOps, and systems architecture. Skilled in mentoring, documentation, and fostering cross-functional collaboration. Proven ability to deliver innovative solutions that drive cost savings, reduce incident response times, and elevate organizational resilience.

CORE COMPETENCIES

DevOps | Research | Mentoring | Technical Documentation | Communication | Adaptability | Cloud Infrastructure (AWS, GCP)

Automation | Problem Solving | Team Leadership & Mentoring | People Management | Infrastructure Engineering Management

Project Management | Complex Systems | Technical Leadership | System Optimization | Systems Design

Troubleshooting | Cross-Functional Collaboration | Systems Engineering | System Architecture | QA/QC | Incident Response

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCIES

- **Programming Languages:** Python, Bash (Advanced), PowerShell (Advanced)
- **Tools & Platforms:** Linux/Unix Systems, Kubernetes, Amazon Web Services (AWS), Google Cloud Platform (GCP), GitHub, Terraform, AWS CloudFormation, Grafana, Splunk, Ansible, Chef, Puppet, Salt, Docker, Apache, MySQL, Nginx, RESTful Web Services, boto3 (AWS SDK), Fabric
- **Technologies:** Kubernetes Administration, Troubleshooting, CI/CD Pipelines, Python & Bash Scripting, REST APIs, Configuration Management, Infrastructure as Code (IaC), Public Cloud Infrastructure, SOA (Service-Oriented Architecture), Microservices, Integration, Testing, SRE Tooling, Containerization, Network Architecture

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Salesforce, San Francisco, CA

Nov 2019 – Apr 2025

Lead Systems Engineer, Remote

Led strategic DevOps and systems initiatives across Mulesoft and Pardot, enabling key security features and delivering scalable, cost-effective infrastructure solutions.

- Spearheaded the 'Bring Your Own Key' (BYOK) initiative, securing \$6M in recurring revenue and satisfying key enterprise customer demands.
- Discovered and resolved critical cloud misconfigurations, saving \$3M annually in AWS infrastructure costs.
- Orchestrated the seamless onboarding of multiple business units to centralized infrastructure, ensuring full documentation and zero service disruptions.
- Designed and implemented a custom CLI tool for managing asynchronous jobs, significantly reducing MTTR and boosting operational visibility.
- Developed a reusable SRE tooling pipeline that reduced tribal knowledge dependencies and improved incident recovery workflows.
- Facilitated alignment and collaboration across multiple teams to deliver infrastructure projects on time and within budget.

Deployment Engineer

Delivered high-stakes technical exam platforms for global tech clients and maintained hybrid cloud infrastructure, supporting internal and customer-facing tools.

- Designed and launched exams for major clients including Google, Elastic, Chef, Linux Foundation, and VMWare, increasing customer base and revenue.
- Mentored junior engineers and built documentation/playbooks, reducing escalations and supporting career development within the team.
- Engineered customized exam environments using Bash and PowerShell, rapidly adapting to client needs across a wide tech stack.
- Contributed to internal infrastructure and codebase supporting AWS and GCP hybrid environments for exam delivery and tooling.
- Created demonstration assessments that expanded company offerings into recruitment-focused products.

Rackspace Hosting, San Antonio, TX

May 2013 – Dec 2017

DevOps Engineer

Built scalable cloud architectures in AWS for regulated industries and led automation efforts to streamline deployments and reduce operational friction.

- Delivered 2–3 tailored AWS deployments per week, adhering to compliance standards (e.g., PCI, HIPAA).
- Authored a Python-based automation framework to accelerate builds, cutting deployment failure rates in half.
- Enhanced customer satisfaction by creating custom tools in Bash and Python that streamlined onboarding and troubleshooting.
- Supported knowledge sharing through active contributions to internal wikis and public blog content.
- Acted as a technical liaison to educate clients on distributed systems and DevOps best practices.

EDUCATION

Associate of Applied Science (AAS) in Computer Forensics — 4.0 GPA

Northwest Vista College – San Antonio, TX

- *Marketable Skills Achievement Award: Linux RHCT*
- *Marketable Skills Achievement Award: Information Security & Assurance*

CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

1. **AWS Certified Solutions Architect**, Amazon Web Services (AWS), Jan 2017 – Jan 2019
2. **Red Hat Certified Engineer (RHCE)**, Red Hat, Apr 2016 – Apr 2019
3. **Red Hat Certified System Administrator (RHCSA)**, Red Hat, Jul 2013 – Apr 2019
4. **CloudU**, Rackspace Technology, Mar 2013
5. **LPIC-1: Linux Server Professional Certification**, Linux Professional Institute (LPI), Mar 2012 – Mar 2017
6. **CompTIA Linux+ (Powered by LPI) Certification**, CompTIA, 2012
7. **Data Center Technical Specialist**, Novell, Mar 2012
8. **SUSE Certified Administrator in Enterprise Linux 11**, SUSE, Mar 2012
9. **Certified Linux Administrator**, Novell, Mar 2012 – Mar 2017
10. **CompTIA Network+ Certification**, CompTIA, Dec 2010
11. **CompTIA Security+ Certification**, CompTIA, Dec 2010
12. **CompTIA A+ Certification**, CompTIA

PUBLICATIONS

1. Henderson, Wes. (Dec 19, 2015). [The Anatomy of an SSH Connection](#). necrux.com.
2. Henderson, Wes. (Apr 28, 2015). Understanding and Adopting a Cloud Mindset for your Emerging Business. Rackspace Blog.

3. Henderson, Wes. (Aug 28, 2014). An Overview Of Disaster Recovery And Mitigation In The Cloud For Emerging Businesses. Rackspace Blog.